

致学校管理者的一封信

A LETTER TO SCHOOL ADMINISTRATORS · DIGITAL LEARNING

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A Letter to School Administrators

· Introducing the Digital Learning course and how to implement it

Date

Fill in

date of this letter

尊敬的校长、教学负责人、信息技术负责人：

Dear Principal, Curriculum Lead, and IT Lead,

This letter introduces a bilingual course called Digital Learning and sets out the ways your school can put it to use. Everything is public and costs nothing; there is no procurement, no licence, and no system to install. You may run the whole course, take a few modules into a course you already teach, or simply give students and families the address. Section 4 states the cost and the return of all three.

— —

The letter takes about twelve minutes. If you have three, read **the facts table in Section 1** and **the three implementation models in Section 4**; everything a decision needs is there.

一、这门课是什么

1. What this course is

AI

Digital Learning is a two-semester public course for secondary students on **learning how to learn, and using technology with judgment in a digital world**. It is not a software-skills course. Students build their own learning website, plan and complete an online course of their own choosing, evaluate the credibility of online resources, work with generative AI and verify what it produces, and close the year with a portfolio explaining how they learned.

二、它解决什么问题

2. The problem it addresses

— —

Most schools already teach a technology course covering how tools work, and use homeroom or moral-education time to talk about online caution. What usually sits in the gap between them is **how a student learns independently, persistently, and methodically when nobody is watching** — which is exactly the condition they will spend most of their lives in after school.

This course fills that gap, and fills it with evidence the student produces: a learning website they maintain, a record of an external course they chose, planned, and finished on their own, and a reflection on their own growth written in their own words.

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Think of it as **a textbook you can teach from immediately, rather than a system you must install** — no server, no account infrastructure, no procurement; open the page and it works. The comparison breaks down in one place: a textbook sitting on a shelf needs nobody, whereas this course, if it is to carry marks and certificates, still needs a person to look at student work each week and respond. Without that person it becomes self-study material — still useful, but missing the force that keeps most secondary students going.

三、学生的一周是什么样

3. What a week costs a student



Each teaching week is **one web page**, and that page is the week's learning: objectives → time estimate → materials (text with embedded video) → follow-along → the week's task with its rubric → a checkable self-review list → an ungraded self-quiz → a reflection prompt → optional extensions → suggested pace → FAQ.

120

” ”

1

The required parts **never exceed 120 minutes** in total, external course time included; anything marked optional is excluded. The course suggests two fixed blocks of about an hour each week. All interaction happens in the browser: no course account is needed, and progress stays in the student's own browser.

There are no late penalties. The course gives a suggested pace instead of a punishment, on the reasoning that the next week does not wait anyway. The holiday rule is built in: no module opens and no task falls due on a statutory holiday — it rolls to the next Sunday — and National Day week, plus one of the spring holiday weeks, are buffer weeks with no new content.

四、三种落地方式

4. Three ways to implement it

This is the heart of the letter. The three models differ only in **how much staffing your school puts in**; the course content is identical in all three.

	Full adoption	Embedded	Open resource
What you provide	30 4–5 mentor per ~30 students, ~4–5 h/week; one tracking sheet	1 1 The existing teacher uses selected modules within existing periods	Only the address, passed on
Students get	Weekly feedback, rubric scores, semester and year certificates	In-class feedback and your own marks	In-page self-checks, quizzes, and a printable completion statement
Best for	Schools opening a full school-based course with staff to assign	Schools with an existing technology, project, or homeroom slot	Motivated students, home study, clubs, libraries
Start-up	One planning and mentor-briefing session	Selecting modules and aligning objectives	Almost none

A ·

A · Full adoption, as designed

16

30

Sixteen teaching weeks per semester, worked through week by week, with one **mentor** per roughly 30 students. Students publish each week's work on their own website and register that page's link on the mentor's tracking sheet; the mentor scores by rubric, replies by email within a week, contacts anyone whose link is missing that same week, and

offers 1:1 video by appointment. **The tracking sheet is the gradebook** — no separate system is needed.

B ·

B · Embedded in a course you already teach

You do not have to run the whole thing. Each of these is self-contained and can stand alone:

- — — **The six digital-basics modules** — email and attachments, screenshots and recording plus a personal website, translation and reading tools, accounts and privacy, search and citation, a personal digital workspace — a natural fit for the opening weeks of a technology course.
- “ ” ” ” — — **“What is learning” and “meaningful digital learning”** — for study-skills, guidance, or homeroom time.
- — — **The external-course thread** — students choose an online course, plan it, log it weekly, and appraise it at the end: a ready-made semester-long independent-study project.
- — — **Digital citizenship and wellbeing, and information credibility** — for moral education and family-facing events.

C ·

C · Open resource

” ”

Assign nobody; simply pass on the address. Students self-assess against the same rubrics and can print a completion statement at the end of a semester. There are no marks and no certificates in this model, but the materials, videos, tasks, and rubrics are exactly the same.

C 4–5 A B— —

Our recommendation: if you can free one teacher for 4–5 hours a week, choose A. If you cannot but already have a technology course or homeroom slot, choose B — it buys most of the benefit with time you already spend. C works well as a trial: let a small group work through it first, then decide whether to scale.

五、人员与工作量

5. Staffing and workload

A mentor does not need to be a technology teacher, and does not need to master every tool the course touches in advance. The pages have already done the teaching; the mentor's job is **to see each student**.

30 4–5

One mentor, about 30 students, roughly 4–5 hours a week, doing four things:

1. 8 **Check progress:** the tracking sheet, each student's site, and the three-line weekly log — about 8 minutes per student.
2. — — / / / **Score by rubric:** each row is one of the module's objectives, rated at four levels — Meets / Developing / Not yet / No evidence.
3. **Reply by email** within a week of the link being registered.
4. **Follow up the same week** with anyone whose link is missing.

Fill in how the mentor handbook is obtained

A separate mentor handbook covers the weekly routine, how to apply the rubrics, a bank of feedback phrasings, common technical problems, and the boundaries of the role — never doing the work for a student, never passing judgment on a family. Fill in how the mentor handbook is obtained

六、技术与网络条件

6. Technology and network requirements

The course keeps its technical footprint deliberately small, because heavy requirements are themselves a barrier to schools.

What your school provides:

- 2 A reliable connection and an up-to-date computer with a current browser — about two hours of access a week. Pages read on a phone, but tasks are best done on a computer.
- A microphone and camera, or a phone, for recording and screenshot tasks.
- 2 An email address each student can use, from Week 2.

What your school does not** need:**

- No learning management system. The course is public web pages; students create no course account.
- No purchase and no licence.
- VPN 5 YouTube Google No VPN. Every material is reachable from mainland China: teaching

videos sit on a mainland-accessible host, run under five minutes, carry bilingual captions, and **each one has a full text version alongside**, so a student on a constrained connection can still complete the week by reading. The course uses no YouTube and no Google-hosted resources, and every external link is access-tested from the mainland before a semester opens.

- **VPN** ” ” The website builder students use requires **only an email address — no phone number and no VPN** — has a free tier, and can be set not to be indexed by search engines.

七、评估与记录

7. Assessment and records

	Semester 1	Semester 2
Formative	30 50 Digital basics 30; four thematic modules 50	65 Six thematic modules 65
Summative	20 20 Semester portfolio	15 20 Capstone 15; year portfolio 20
Total	100	100

- ≥ 60 ≥ 85 ” ”
Passing and certificates: ≥ 60 in a semester passes and earns the semester certificate; ≥ 85 is marked with distinction; passing both semesters earns the year certificate.
- — — / /
/ **Rubrics:** every graded task page carries its rubric; the rows are that module’s objectives, rated Meets / Developing / Not yet / No evidence. Marks therefore trace directly back to named objectives, which makes them straightforward to explain to families and to your own administration.
- **Self-review and self-quizzes never count toward the grade:** they are retakeable, give instant feedback, and exist for self-monitoring.
- **The evidence lives on the student’s own website**, which is a ready-made portfolio at the end of a semester — usable for school exhibitions, applications, or parents’ evenings.
- A **learning self-check** at the start and end of each semester lets students see their own starting point and progress; it does not count toward the grade.

八、隐私与学生保护

8. Privacy and safeguarding

- The course asks students to publish on the open Internet, so the protections are part of the design rather than an appendix to it.
- Student sites are **pseudonymous and not indexed by search engines** by default.
 - **No face photographs and no full school name.**
 - The course pages **require no account**, collect no student information, and keep progress only in the student's own browser.
 - — —
No forums, no groups, no peer review — personal reflection replaces public interaction, so there is no peer-comment space to moderate.
 - At the end of Semester 2, a student who wishes to make their portfolio public needs **written parental consent**.
 - A separate *Letter to Parents* explains to families how the course runs, what a week looks like, and how they can concretely help; it is available for you to use as it stands.

九、学术诚信与人工智能的使用

9. Academic integrity and the use of AI

AI AI

The course neither avoids generative AI nor treats it as a synonym for cheating. Every task carries one of three labels stating how AI may be used in it:

Label	Meaning
	AI This task must be done independently, without AI
	AI AI may assist, provided its use is described
	AI The task is itself an examination of what AI does; record it faithfully

AI

The label is printed on the task page itself, so students and mentors work from the same rule. A full module in Semester 2 is devoted to learning with AI: verifying what it produces and making evidence-based decisions about what to accept.

十、落地时间线

10. A rollout timeline

Given in relative time; map it onto your own school calendar.

When	What to do
Before the semester	A / B / C A 16 Choose the model; if A, name the mentors and create one tracking sheet; map the 16 weeks onto this year's calendar and mark the buffer weeks; access-test the course pages and the website builder from your own school network.
1 Week 1	Students work through orientation; the <i>Letter to Parents</i> goes out.
2-3 Weeks 2-3	3 — — Students begin using email; in Week 3 they build their websites — the peak of technical support demand, so plan help in advance.
4-7 Weeks 4-7	7 Digital basics; in Week 7 each student chooses their external course.
Midpoint	— — Use the tracking sheet to confirm every student has a website that opens; this is where students are most likely to fall behind.
15-16 Weeks 15-16	Semester portfolio and reflection; totals and certificates.
Between semesters	60 No required work; students may optionally continue their external course at up to 60 minutes a week.

十一、我们请学校提供的

11. What we ask of the school

1. — —
One stable weekly slot. Whichever model you choose, give students a predictable two hours — at school or at home. What defeats an asynchronous course is not difficulty but the absence of a fixed place in the week.
 2. **A place with a connection and recording capability**, especially for students whose home equipment or connection cannot support the work; let them complete it at school.
 3. **A 4–5** **If you choose model A: one mentor, 4–5 hours a week.** They need not be a technology teacher.
 4. **Send the Letter to Parents to families.** Completion rates differ noticeably when parents understand how the course works and what their part is — and is not.
 5. **Run one access test from your own school network before you begin.** Open a course page, a teaching video, and the website builder once each — a few minutes' work that prevents a chaotic first week.
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十二、几个常见的顾虑

12. Common concerns

- “ ” — —
- C
- “Without supervision, won’t students simply stop?”** Some will. That is precisely why the weekly progress check and the same-week follow-up exist — not as administrative gestures but as the only way to notice a student slipping early. Model C has no such layer, which is why it suits students who already study independently.
- “ ”
- A 4–5 B
- “Won’t this add a lot to teachers’ workload?”** The content, videos, tasks, rubrics, quizzes, and the parent letter are already built, so there is no lesson preparation. The real load in model A is 4–5 hours a week of reviewing and responding. In model B it is close to nothing.
- “ ” B “ ”
- “We have no spare periods.”** Then choose model B. The six digital-basics modules slot into an existing technology course; “what is learning” fits study-skills or homeroom time; and the external-course thread is a ready-made independent-study project on its own.
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13. Using the course, and getting in touch

Everything is public and free to use and adapt for teaching in your school. Fill in licence
terms or attribution requirement

Item	/ Address / contact
Course site (syllabus, weekly pages, rubrics, calendar)	Fill in course site URL
Adoption enquiries	Fill in name and email of the contact for adoption
Resources for educators	Fill in URL of the educator resources page

In closing

With warm regards,

The Digital Learning Course Team